

1. INT. THE COUNSELLOR ROOM-DAY

Two bruised boys sit before the COUNSELLOR. She flips through a file, trying to make sense of it.

Meanwhile,

[CAMERA: Wide establishing shot of the room. Slow push-in toward the boys]

BOY 2 (SMIRKS AT THE FIRST BOY)
It looks like your designer clothes
were unable to hide the bruises....

BOY 1 (IRRITATELY)
Atleast, I don't need my father's
money to hide it.

The Counsellor who is sitting in the room trying to figure out what had happened lashed out in anger.

[CAMERA: Tight close-up on Counsellor's face, anger boiling. Hand slams desk in frame]

COUNSELLOR (ANGIRLY)
Shut up both of you, what do you
guys think about yourself. This is
your school not a fight club....

BOY 2 (CUTTING COUNSELLOR IN BETWEEN)
Do you know what you just did? My
father litteraly built this school.
If he finds out you shouted at me,
it won't be a reprimand - it'll be
a reckoning.

Silence swallowed the room. The counsellor's face went cold - his words landed slow and deliberate, like a verdict nobody wanted to hear.

BOY 2 (CONTINUING TO ACT SMART,
SHOUTED AT BOY 1)
And you piece of shit... just wait
till the moment my father buys off
your father's company. Then I will
show the consequences for going
against me...

2. CUT TO.

3. FLASHBACK- INT THE CLASS ROOM- DAY

A SMALL CLASS, A CAMPAIGN POSTER HALF-TORN. THE CLASS TEACHER STANDS AT THE FRONT, HOLDING A PILE OF VOTE SLIPS.

[CAMERA: Wide shot of the classroom, capturing restless students, the torn poster in frame]

CLASS TEACHER (ANNOUNCED)
So – there's a draw between the two
candidates... (REFERRING TO BOY 1
AND CHIRAG) For class rep. The last
vote – Boy 1's – will decide who is
it going to be...

BOY 2 WHO KNEW ABOUT HIS POPULARITY IN THE SCHOOL AND THE
FACT THAT HIS FATHER WAS GOING TO BUY BOY 1 FATHER'S COMPANY
HE WAS QUITE CONFIDENT ABOUT THE VOTE.

BUT THE UNEXPECTED HAPPENED...

CUT TO.

PRESENT- INT. THE COUNSELLOR ROOM- DAY.

COUNSELLOR (ANGIRLY)
Enough.....

She storms towards boy 1 and gives him a tight slap. Both the
boys were in shock of what exactly happened.

It was a mental breakdown, because of all the things that
have been going in her life...

COUNSELLOR (GETTING BACK TO SENSE,
MURMURS TO HERSELF)
"Oh God... what did I just do?"

[CAMERA: Handheld shaky shot as she lowers her gaze – making
the audience feel her collapse]

Before anyone could have reacted to that statement.

CUT TO.

4. EXT. A LUXURIOUS CAR COMES AT THE GATE OF THE SCHOO.

THE DOORS OPEN. BOY 1'S MOTHER, ELEGANT FROM HEAD TO TOE,
STEPS OUT. HER HEELS STRIKE THE PAVEMENT WITH AUTHORITY.

[CAMERA: Tracking shot from her feet upward, tilting slowly
to reveal her perfectly styled look]

CUT TO.

5. INT- THE COUNSELLOR OFFICE- DAY

[CAMERA: Medium close-up on her face, her polished composure
cracking just slightly]

MOTHER (ANXIOUSLY)
Is there something wrong with my
son I recieved a call from the
school

She looks towards his son as he is an inconvenience.

FATHER (QUIETER, HUMBLE, LATE 40s) ENTERS BEHIND HER. HIS
EYES FLICK TO HIS SON WITH A MIX OF GUILT AND WORRY.

FATHER
We... we got the message. Is he
alright?

[CAMERA: Two-shot of the parents – her stiff posture against
his weary slump – a silent portrait of their fractured
dynamic]

THE COUNSELLOR RISES, PLACES THE FILE DOWN CAREFULLY.

COUNSELLOR
He and another student were
involved in a fight. We're trying
to understand and resolve it.

MOTHER (CUTTING IN, SHARP)
A fight? How embarrassing. We will
handle this discretely. This is
about our reputation...

Boy 1 who had enough...

BOY 1 (SNAPS, FEEDING THE FIRE)
Reputation? Don't you even care
that I got punched? You come here
like nothing happened!

MOTHER (COLD, DISMISSIVE)
Injuries are unfortunate. But
consequences for behavior are a
different matter. We can't have our
son tarnished by street violence.

FATHER (STEADY, BUT GUILT-RIDDEN)
(quietly to Mother) Let's hear them
out first.

Mother looks towards the father in an ugly manner.

MOTHER (IN LOW VOICE IRRITATINGLY)
You always let things slide. That's
why he's like this.

BOY 2 WATCHES THE EXCHANGE – HIS SMILE SLOWLY SLOUGHS INTO
SOMETHING HARD.

[CAMERA: Insert – Boy 2 in the background]

BOY 2 (IN A MEAN WAY TO MOTHER)
 Maybe if your son showed up for
 class once in a while instead of
 posing at dinners, he'd learn more
 than how to threaten people.

[CAMERA: Quick reaction shot – Counsellor's eyes widen,
 stunned. Push-in close-up on Mother's face as fury flashes
 across it]

COUNSELLOR WAS SHOCKED TO HEAR THAT...

MOTHER (FURY FLASHING)
 Excuse me?

THE ROOM SPIRALS: PARENTS READY TO DEFEND, COUNSELLOR TRYING
 TO INTERVENE, BOYS REIGNITED.

[CAMERA: Wide shot – chaos unfolding, everyone talking over
 each other]

COUNSELLOR (RAISING HER VOICE OVER TO
 TAKE CONTROL OVER THE ROOM)
 Enough! This isn't helping. Parents
 – please. Let's speak calmly.
 Violence is not the answer.

Boy 1 lashes out..

BOY 1 (SHOUTING OVER THE TOP OF HIS
 THROAT)
 Calm? You want calm? He hit me! And
 you think I should apologize
 because your family business is
 fragile?

THE FATHER OF BOY 2, WHO HAD BEEN SILENT UNTIL NOW, STEPS
 FORWARD – HE'S NOT WHAT YOU'D EXPECT: WORN HANDS, EYES HOLD
 STEEL.

FATHER (CALMLY)
 My son doesn't need defending with
 money. He's not here for your
 threats.

Meanwhile Mother lashes out on the counsellor

MOTHER
 Is it... Is it really happening in
 front of you, and you're, instead
 of taking action against him,
 trying to calm us down...

It was the exact moment the father of boy 2 enters the room.
 He looks at the mother of boy 1 shouting at the counsellor.

CUT TO.

Counsellor explained everything to the father of boy 2 (who is an intelligent, calm and a self made man)

FATHER OF BOY 2 (CALMY ADDRESSING THE ROOM)

This isn't about business. This is about two boys who got into a fight.

THERE IS A BEAT. THE COUNSELLOR SEIZES IT.

COUNSELLOR (LOOKING FROM PARENT TO PARENT)

You can threaten one another across boardrooms and family dinners, but it filters down – into kids, into hallways. They learn what you model. We are here because they were hurt. Not because one of you can buy the school. Not because someone wants revenge.

[CAMERA: Medium shot panning slowly across each parent, catching their reactions in silence]

Mother still trying to defend the reputation

MOTHER

We will not have our name sullied.
He needs discipline.

Both the fathers look at each other and father of boy 1 answers calmy...

FATHER OF BOY 1

Discipline without listening is cruelty. Remember why we wanted better for him.

Mother of Boy 1 who is still not entirely convinced.

MOTHER (HARD-EDGED, BUT NOT ENTIRELY WITHOUT CRACKS)

We'll talk later. (TO THE COUNSELLOR) Handle this.

Counsellor showing full confidence, makes the parents believe that a necessary counselling session will take place and she will go through them once again and will try to resolve the matter for once and for all.....

BOY 1 AND BOY 2 STARE AT EACH OTHER – OLD RIVALRY, NEW UNEASE. [THE CAMERA LINGERS ON THEIR FACES AS THE SCENE FADES OUT.]

FADE OUT.